PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience delivering hands-on security operations, threat detection, and incident response in complex enterprise environments. I specialise in CrowdStrike Falcon for Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Identity, and Microsoft 365 (M365), and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations using Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL). At University of the Arts London I have led the monitoring, detection, and investigation of security incidents across an estate of 8,000 users, using Extended Detection and Response (XDR) capabilities to identify threats across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network domains. I combine deep technical expertise in threat hunting, detection engineering, and vulnerability management with strong knowledge of Azure Active Directory, Amazon Web Services (AWS), and M365 security controls, making me well-suited to drive security operations at scale in a hybrid environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, KQL, detection rule authoring, alert triage, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, digital forensics, root cause analysis, containment and remediation
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hunting across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network layers using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Sentinel
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Email and Endpoint Management:** Mimecast, Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Firewall and Network:** Check Point Harmony, network traffic analysis
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR playbook development
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Cloud Platforms:** Microsoft Azure, AWS, M365

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead security operations across an 8,000-user estate, monitoring and investigating alerts from CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, and Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM and XDR platform
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Sentinel KQL queries, identifying threats across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network environments before they escalate
- Lead incident response lifecycle end-to-end in accordance with NIST 800-61, including detection, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, mapping findings to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Author and continuously improve detection rules, correlation queries, and SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to reduce mean time to detect and respond
- Oversee vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation to identify, prioritise, and remediate weaknesses across the enterprise
- Administer and optimise Azure Active Directory (Entra ID) Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and SSO configurations to strengthen identity security

- Manage Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) to detect and investigate identity-based threats, lateral movement, and privilege escalation
- Collaborate with infrastructure and cloud teams on AWS and Azure security posture improvements, including M365 security configuration reviews
- Produce executive-level and operational security reporting, translating technical threat findings into business-risk context for senior stakeholders
- Govern endpoint security through BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management and Mobile Application Management policies

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Delivered day-to-day Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions, triaging and investigating security events across CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender, escalating confirmed incidents for response
- Supported deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across the 8,000-user estate, configuring policies, tuning detections, and onboarding devices
- Performed alert correlation and analysis within Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, identifying patterns indicative of phishing, malware, credential abuse, and lateral movement
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and Tenable.io, tracking remediation with internal teams and reporting on risk reduction progress
- Managed email security using Mimecast, investigating phishing campaigns, creating block and allow policies, and delivering user security awareness guidance
- Supported identity governance reviews in Azure Active Directory, including access reviews, Conditional Access policy tuning, and MFA rollout
- Contributed to the development and testing of incident response playbooks aligned to the NIST 800-61 framework
- Assisted with Cyber Essentials Plus assessments, gathering evidence and supporting remediation to maintain certification

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)
IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered security and infrastructure engineering for a Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, maintaining endpoint security, patching cycles, and identity controls
- Managed endpoint protection tools and supported cloud security configurations in AWS and Azure
- Implemented and managed Multi-Factor Authentication and Single Sign-On solutions to protect user accounts and reduce credential-based attack risk
- Assisted with internal security audits, ensuring alignment with ISO 27001 and CIS Controls frameworks
- Provided technical support for security tooling, network infrastructure, and device management across the organisation

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 users at UAL, improving EDR coverage and reducing mean time to detect across the endpoint estate
- Developed a comprehensive library of Sentinel KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, significantly improving threat visibility across identity, endpoint, and cloud domains
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Discover modules, enabling advanced threat correlation and asset discovery across the enterprise
- Led UAL to successful Cyber Essentials Plus recertification by identifying and remediating critical gaps across network, endpoint, and identity controls
- Automated repetitive SOC investigation tasks using PowerShell and SOAR playbooks, reducing analyst workload and accelerating incident response timelines
- Conducted proactive threat hunts using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation outputs, identifying high-risk attack paths before they could be exploited by adversaries

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)